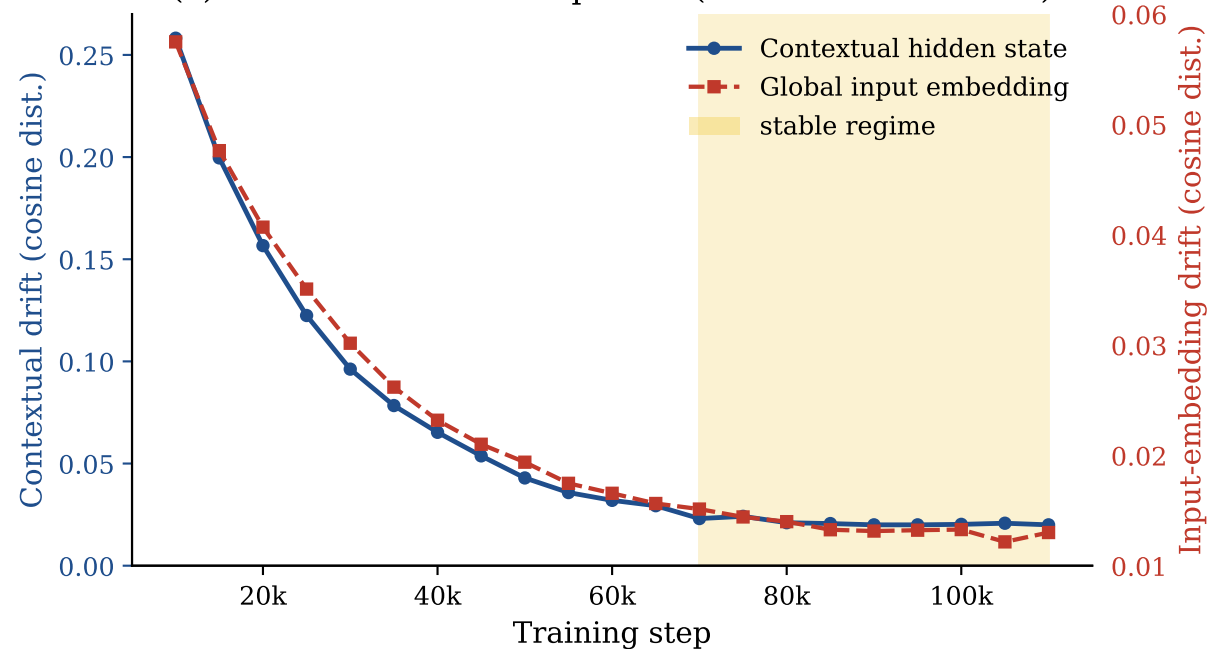
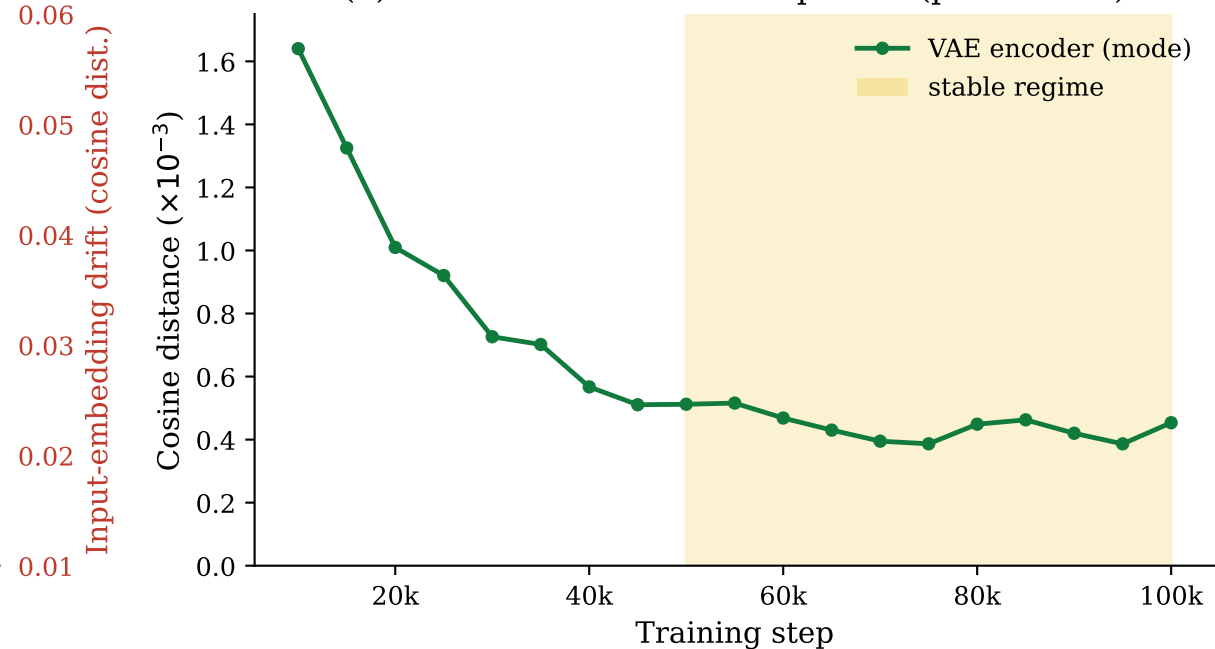


Representation-space stability: AR model (from scratch) vs. VAE encoder (pre-trained, frozen for DiT)

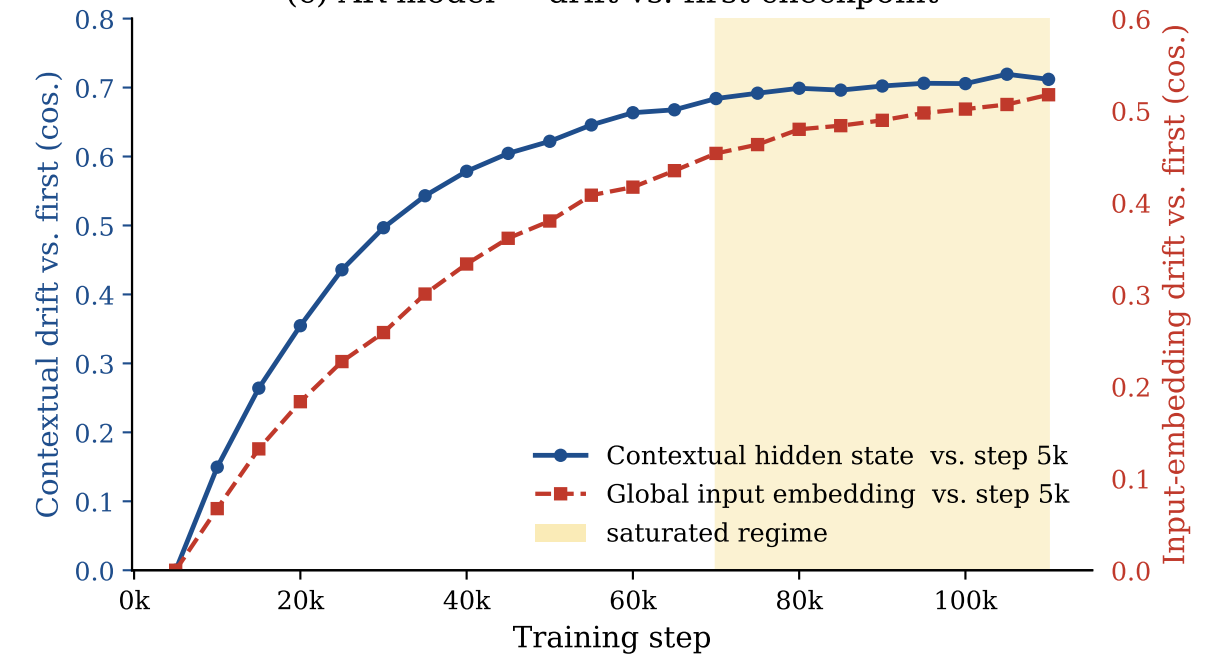
(a) AR model — inter-step drift (trained from scratch)



(b) VAE encoder — inter-step drift (pre-trained)



(c) AR model — drift vs. first checkpoint



(d) VAE encoder — drift vs. first checkpoint

